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‘ICE Out’ pledge divides aldermen

Amid push for campaign finance reform, many on City Council vow to turn down funds from 12 companies; some others call it empty gesture

By Jake Sheridan and A.D. Quig
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

A pledge signed by nearly half of Chicago’s aldermen to reject campaign contributions from companies allegedly tied to federal immigration crackdowns has split the City Council — with supporters calling it a critical show of solidarity and detractors dismissing it as an insincere political gesture.

The “ICE Out” pledge has garnered signatures from 21 aldermen since its launch in late July. Each promised not to accept money from 12 businesses that activists say have profited from President

Donald Trump’s strong-armed deportation campaign, including its Immigration and Customs Enforcement agency, with many using the pledge as proof of their anti-Trump bona fides.

But a Tribune analysis found the targeted companies have contributed \$1.16 million since 2010 to every aldermanic candidate, sitting alderman, ward organization and city candidate combined. Of that, only about \$381,000 has gone to the campaign accounts of the 50 current council members — a small fraction of what those aldermen have raised in total during that time.

Several council members who declined to sign the pledge argue the effort is misdirected. And even some who signed it acknowledge that dollar figures are not really the point. To one who signed, Ald. Jessie Fuentes, 26th, the pledge is about showing her Humboldt Park ward that she won’t accept money tied to the “federal terrorism” that has hit the neighborhood in the last year.

“Contributions come with commitments. They come with alignments. They come with values articulated,” Fuentes said. “It doesn’t matter if it’s \$10,000, if it’s \$1,000, if it’s \$500.”

That tension — a money-targeting pledge that ultimately has little initial impact on how much money



Jane Ruby, president of the League of Women Voters of Chicago, is a lead organizer in a campaign urging City Council members to pledge not to accept money from companies allegedly tied to federal immigration crackdowns. **JOHN J. KIM/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

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ARMANDO L. SANCHEZ/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

STUNT DOUBLE

Members of the U.S. Air Force Thunderbirds perform during the Chicago Air and Water Show above North Avenue Beach on Sunday in Chicago. The two-day spectacle draws more than a million people to the city’s lakefront beaches every year. This year it included demonstrations from the U.S. Army Parachute Team, nicknamed the Golden Knights, and the Thunderbirds. **Story in Chicagoland, Page A3**

Century-old White House replica faces demolition

Backlash against plan for Castle Eden grows in southwest suburb

By Robert Channick
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

While the White House is in limbo with the East Wing demolished and President Donald Trump’s ballroom tied up in court, a complete one-tenth scale replica of the Executive Mansion in southwest suburban Darien may be facing an even greater existential threat — the wrecking ball.

A de facto local landmark and drive-by curiosity along a frontage road off I-55, the 123-year-old building known as Castle Eden is notable both for its resemblance to its larger Washington inspiration and its own unusual history.

Built in 1903 on the once-abundant farmland of DuPage County, the White House replica was originally the summer home of noted

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A downed tree lies across North Ashland Avenue in Rogers Park on July 27 amid a wave of storms in the Chicago area. **EILEEN T. MESLAR/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Study: Protecting mature trees saves lives

Canopy helps reduce deaths from high heat

By Adriana Pérez
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Even a minuscule, 0.03% increase in Chicago’s tree canopy each year could save the lives of more than 100 residents citywide by offering relief from extreme heat, a recent study found. But

that has to happen while keeping current mature trees alive, researchers say, as increasingly intense severe storms like last week’s knock them down, uproot them and fling away their branches.

The research from Northwestern University also found that yearly increases in tree canopy cover in Chicago neighborhoods were associated with lower death rates and a reduced risk of dying

from heart, lung, mental health and some musculoskeletal conditions.

For context, the city had almost 4 million trees in the most recent tree census conducted by the Morton Arboretum in 2020, averaging 27 trees per acre across its 150,000 acres. Ten years earlier, the U.S. Forest Service counted 3.6 million.

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US-Iran deadline shows goals shifted

Day arrives, but deal reportedly replaced by economic warfare

By Aaron Boxerman, Zolan Kanno-Youngs and David E. Sanger
THE NEW YORK TIMES

JERUSALEM — President Donald Trump’s ceasefire with Iran in June envisioned a broader deal to end the war and rein in the country’s nuclear program, all negotiated within 60 days.

But that deadline, set to pass on Monday, has been essentially abandoned, and the war has transformed into a contest of willpower and economic endurance that has no end in sight.

There have been no publicly reported U.S. strikes on Iranian targets since late July. Yet the effective collapse of the agreement underscores how Trump has struggled to end the war he started in February alongside Israel, and how far he remains from the ambitions of the June deal, including fully reopening the Strait of Hormuz, a critical waterway where Iran has choked off oil and gas shipping since the fighting began.

Those inside the White House are well aware that they will blow past Monday’s deadline and that the conflict has largely morphed into one of economic warfare, according to two Americans familiar with the negotiations.

The current strategy bears a striking resemblance to previous, yearslong U.S. attempts to isolate Iran in the hopes of compelling it to abandon its nuclear ambitions. The policy

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INSIDE

Dems schedule 2028 primaries

Democrats seeking the presidential nomination in 2028 will need to prove themselves early on in states where Black and Latino voters and union members are key supporters. **Nation & World, B1**

White Sox finish sweep of Tigers

Munetaka Murakami hit a tie-breaking two-run home run in the seventh inning on Sunday and the White Sox completed a three-game sweep of the Detroit Tigers with a 7-5 victory. **Sports, C1**

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